

English Exam

Name: _____ ID: _____

I. READING COMPREHENSION (10 points)

A. Read through the text and then do the multiple choice exercise.

THE PEACELIKE MONGOOSE

In cobra country a mongoose was born one day who didn't want to fight cobras or anything else. The word spread from mongoose to mongoose that there was a mongoose that didn't want to fight cobras. If he didn't want to fight anything else, it was his own business, but it was the duty of every mongoose to kill cobras or be killed by cobras.

"Why?" asked the peacelike mongoose, and the word went round that the strange new mongoose was not only pro-cobra and anti-mongoose but intellectually curious and against the ideals and traditions of mongoosism.

"He is crazy," cried the young mongoose's father.

"He's sick," said his mother,

"He is a coward," shouted his brothers.

"He's a mongoosesexual," whispered his sisters.

Strangers who never had laid eyes on the peacelike mongoose remembered that they had seen him crawling on his stomach, or trying cobra hoods, or plotting the violent overthrow of Mongoodia.

"I'm trying to use reason and intelligence," said the strange new mongoose.

"Reason is six-sevenths of treason," said one of his neighbours.

"Intelligence is what the enemy uses," said another.

Finally the rumour spread that the mongoose had venom in his sting, like a cobra, and he was tried, convicted by a show of paws, and condemned to banishment.

Moral: Ashes to ashes, and clay to clay, if the enemy doesn't get you your own folks may.

1. Cobras and mongooses are animals who
 - a. get along well with each other.
 - b. live peacefully side by side.
 - c. wage war against each other.
2. "Convict" and "condemn" belong to the vocabulary of
 - a. religion.
 - b. politics.
 - c. justice.
3. The word "spread" suggests that
 - a. they all told each other the news.
 - b. no mongoose was interested in the event.
 - c. the news was kept secret.

4. "Reason is six-sevenths of treason" implies that
- the neighbour was only interested in how the words sounded.
 - you can always create new words by adding a letter.
 - by using reason the peacelike mongoose is very close to being a traitor to his own folks.
5. In this story, the following events take place:
- the strange mongoose is convicted.
 - the strange mongoose refuses to fight cobras.
 - his family turns against him.
 - he is banished from the country.
 - strangers accuse him of being sold to the enemy.

The order of events is:

- 1 2 3 4 5
 - 3 1 2 5 4
 - 2 3 5 1 4
6. What does not belong to the ideals and traditions of mongoosism?
- being brave.
 - killing cobras.
 - using reason and intelligence.
7. "Plotting the overthrow" suggests
- conspiring against the existing government.
 - accepting the present state of affairs.
 - agreeing with the present leaders' policy.
8. "Had never laid eyes" means
- hadn't seen him before.
 - had been watching him for a longtime.
 - had already seen him.
9. A coward is a person
- who can easily control his fear.
 - who is not courageous.
 - who likes to fight.
10. The story and its moral
- are purely fictional and have no symbolical meaning.
 - can only apply to the world of cobras and mongooses.
 - are meant to reflect the relationships among human beings.

11. Choose the words in the right list with its synonym:

Paw: _____ Sting: _____
Banishment: _____ Peacelike: _____
Clay: _____ Whispered: _____
Duty: _____ Treason: _____

II. HIV BREAKTHROUGH (10 points)

B. Read through the text. Then fill in the blanks using the best option from each item in the multiple choice exercise below.

Scientists believe that they have made a _____ (1) breakthrough in fighting HIV - they have shown what happens when an infection fighting antibody attacks a _____ (2) in HIV's _____ (3) defences. Finding a vaccine against HIV has been very difficult because the proteins on the surface of the virus are continually mutating, but they have shown an antibody, called b12, attacking a weak spot on the virus where the protein is _____ (4). The virus is able to _____ (5) rapidly to avoid _____ (6) by the immune system, and is also covered in sugary molecules which block access by antibodies. _____ (7), certain parts of the virus must remain _____ (8) unchanged so that it can catch hold of and enter human cells.

One protein that sticks out from the surface of the virus and binds to receptors on host cells is one such region, which makes it a target for vaccine development.

Previous analyses of the _____ (9) of people that have been able to keep HIV from developing into AIDS for long periods of time _____ (10) revealed a _____ (11) group of antibodies - including b12 - that seem to fight HIV with some degree of _____ (12).

III. GRAMMAR (25 points)

C. Choose the best answer for the following sentences:

1. The train _____ left.
 - a. Has
 - b. Have
2. "I've been here _____ Monday."
 - a. Since
 - b. For
3. "I looked _____ my wallet everywhere."
 - a. For
 - b. Off
4. " _____ the plane lands, I'll give you a call."
 - a. On
 - b. As soon as
5. "Put on the jackets. Put _____ on."
 - a. Them
 - b. It
6. "This is the man _____ bought the package."
 - a. Who
 - b. What

7. "Oscar's whole family play tennis but Oscar plays the _____."
- a. Better
 - b. Best
8. "The movie _____ started when we got to the theater."
- a. Had
 - b. Have
9. "_____ 1975 my grandfather had brought his entire family to Venezuela."
- a. By
 - b. On
10. "The plane had _____ landed."
- a. Already
 - b. So
11. "People enjoy _____ in cities."
- a. Living
 - b. To live
12. "I suggest _____ the bus instead the subway."
- a. To take
 - b. Taking
13. "Alejandro refused _____."
- a. To leave
 - b. Leaving
14. "It's so hot today. I feel _____ going swimming."
- a. Like
 - b. On
15. "Camila looks like her father. She takes _____ him in so many ways, too."
- a. After
 - b. Like
16. "We can't go out tonight unless we find someone to look _____ the children."
- a. Like
 - b. After
17. "Caty will stay in the apartment _____ I get back."
- a. Until
 - b. On
18. "I was never good at solving math problems. Solving means:"

- a. Work on
 - b. Work out
19. "Francisco went back after _____ lunch."
- a. To eat
 - b. Eating
20. "Gloria insisted _____ doing the dishes."
- a. In
 - b. On
21. "I can't make _____ my mind whether to go to France or Italy for my vacation."
- a. Off
 - b. Up
22. "If I study English, I _____ pass the test."
- a. Will
 - b. Would
23. "The package has _____ mailed."
- a. Been
 - b. Being
24. "If I had a car, I _____ visit you."
- a. Would
 - b. Will
25. "They regret _____ bought the house."
- a. Having
 - b. To have been
26. "If I _____ you, I'd be more careful."
- a. Am
 - b. Were
27. "We have finished the job. The job _____ been finished."
- a. Have
 - b. Has
28. "Perform _____"
- a. Ant
 - b. Ance
29. "I had the mechanic _____ my car."
- a. Repair

- b. Repaired
30. "I had my car _____"
- a. Repaired
b. Repair
31. "I asked you _____"
- a. To come
b. Come
32. "Every one jumped from the quickly _____ ship."
- a. Sink
b. Sinking
33. "We _____ have finished our project by next June."
- a. Had
b. Will
34. "Years ago, I used to _____ in Barcelona."
- a. Live
b. Living
35. "I am used to _____ in New York."
- a. Living
b. Live
36. "Nancy went to lunch. So _____ Julio."
- a. Do
b. Did
37. "The computers don't work. Neither _____ the lamp."
- a. Does
b. Do
38. "You are my friend, _____ you?"
- a. Are
b. Aren't
39. "Paul said 'I need the money'."
- a. Paul said that he need the money.
b. Paul said that he needed the money.
40. He is thought _____ intelligent.
- a. To be
b. Be

41. If I had arrived on time, I _____ not have missed the train.
- a. Will
 - b. Would
42. You suggest that you _____ on time.
- a. To be
 - b. Be
43. I _____ a mistake.
- a. Make
 - b. Do
44. You _____ your homework.
- a. Make
 - b. Do
45. I wish I _____ German.
- a. Know
 - b. Knew
46. I wish I had _____ English.
- a. Know
 - b. Known
47. I would _____ go home.
- a. Rather
 - b. Prefer
48. I had _____ go home.
- a. Best
 - b. Better
49. _____ tall is your mother?
- a. What
 - b. How
50. What's the weather _____?
- a. As
 - b. Like

IV. TRANSLATION (10 points)**D. Choose the correct translation into Spanish for the following sentences:**

1. "The nodes are found to be enlarged"
 - a. Se encuentra que los nódulos están alargados.
 - b. Qué tan alargados los nódulos se encuentran.
 - c. Los nódulos parecen estar algo alargados.
2. "There may be excess of blood"
 - a. Allí puede estar el exceso de sangre.
 - b. Puede haber exceso de sangre.
 - c. Puede estar allí el exceso de sangre.
3. "They were known to undergo changes"
 - a. Eran conocidos por estar sufriendo.
 - b. Se conocía que sufrían cambios.
 - c. Se conocían por los cambios que estaban sufriendo.
4. "There soon follow changes"
 - a. Los cambios vienen.
 - b. Habrá cambios.
 - c. Pronto vienen cambios.
5. "On exercise the pain became stronger"
 - a. Durante el ejercicio es más fuerte este que el dolor.
 - b. Durante el dolor el ejercicio se hará más fuerte.
 - c. Durante el ejercicio el dolor se hace más fuerte.
6. "It's work approximates that of the left"
 - a. Su trabajo al que se aproxima es al que sale de la izquierda.
 - b. El que sale de la izquierda es al que se aproxima.
 - c. Su trabajo se aproxima al de la izquierda.
7. "They estimated the blood leaving the coronary vessels"
 - a. Calcularon la sangre que deja los vasos coronarios.
 - b. Calcularon dejar que los vasos coronarios de ellos sangre.
 - c. Los vasos coronarios calcularon la sangre que ellos dejaron.
8. "The happier the better"
 - a. Cuanto más feliz mejor.
 - b. Cuanto mayor sea la felicidad mejor.
 - c. El más feliz es el mejor.
9. "The changes to be considered"

- a. Considera cambios al estar.
 - b. Los cambios considerados al ser.
 - c. Los cambios a considerarse.
10. "They develop slowly"
- a. El desarrollo es lento.
 - b. Lo desarrollan muy lentamente.
 - c. Se desarrollan lentamente.

V. HOMOPHONES (5 points)

E. Fill in the blanks with the correct word. Both options have the same pronunciation but a different meaning.

1. (break / brake) "He managed to stop the car safely using the hand _____."
2. (great / grate) "Finally, _____ some parmesan cheese and put it on your pasta."
3. (naval / navel) "He comes from a _____ family; all his brothers are sailors."
4. (pain / pane) "If you have a _____ in the chest, you should see a doctor."
5. (paste / paced) "He _____ backwards and forwards in front of the door."

VI. VOCABULARY (5 points)

F. Complete the sentences with the appropriate word.

1. I am _____ snakes.
She's _____ the baby; he doesn't look very well.
2. Come and sit down _____ me.
_____ managing the shop, he also teaches in the evening.
3. The _____ brought the Rolls Royce to the hotel's main entrance.
He's got a job as a bus _____.
4. I haven't seen her _____ this morning.
I've _____ done my shopping.
5. Please, can we go home _____?
It looks quite small, but _____ it is over 5 metres high.

VII. GENERAL KNOWLEDGE (5 points)**G. Choose the correct answer.**

1. "The Teacher Training System" in Spanish is:
 - a. El sistema del profesor en el entrenamiento.
 - b. El sistema de entrenamiento del profesor.
 - c. El profesor entrenando el sistema.
 - d. El entrenamiento para el sistema del profesor.
2. The number: 28.73 is in decimals:
 - a. Two thousand eight hundred and seventy three hundredths.
 - b. Twenty eight and seventy three hundredths.
 - c. Twenty eight hundred seventy three decimals.
 - d. Two hundred eighty seven and three decimals.
3. One metre is equivalent to:
 - a. 4.08 feet
 - b. 3.28 feet
 - c. 2.88 feet
 - d. 3.65 feet
4. An addition connector is:
 - a. If
 - b. First
 - c. Furthermore
 - d. For example
5. A result connector is:
 - a. Therefore
 - b. Unlike
 - c. And
 - d. In short
6. "Carpet" means in Spanish:
 - a. Alfombra
 - b. Carpeta
 - c. Carro-mascota
 - d. Ninguna de las anteriores
7. "No usual" in English is:
 - a. Inusual
 - b. Disusual
 - c. Nusual

- d. Unusual
- 8. Albert Einstein wrote this science book:
 - a. Mathematical Principles
 - b. The Cosmic Connection Theory
 - c. A Brief History of Time
 - d. Relativity General Theory
- 9. Hydrogen is a Gas:
 - a. Mercury is a Liquid
 - b. Oxygen is a Breath
 - c. Air is a Life Agent
 - d. Steel is a Solid
- 10. El Phrasal Verb de "Admirar" es:
 - a. Get Up To
 - b. Get Along Well
 - c. Looking Forward To
 - d. Look Up To

VIII. LISTENING SECTION

Listen to the recording while reading the text below. Write the missing words in the blanks.

Historic letters get responses

Many years ago, an old woman named Peggy Ford wrote letters to some men. The men were soldiers _____ (1) were fighting in the Vietnam War. The soldiers were in combat, far away from their home. They _____ (2) their families, and they liked to get the letters from Peggy. Peggy also kept the letters that the soldiers wrote back to her. Peggy Ford died more than 30 years ago. Earlier this year, Ford's children _____ (3) the letters in her attic. They decided to donate the letters to a history museum. The museum is happy to have the letters. They feel that the _____ (4) stories of the war are valuable. They tell the story of the war better than anyone else could. The museum feels that it's important to remember the war. The letters show a personal perspective of the war. They are a valuable part of history.

A _____ (5) station filmed a story about Peggy Ford and the letters. The story was posted on the internet. Many people saw the story, and read about Ford's letters to the soldiers. The story made other people want to donate their letters. Many people called the museum. They _____ (6) to donate their letters from that era. One woman gave the museum more than 200 letters that she wrote to her husband while he was _____ (7) in Vietnam. She had _____ (8) them for many years. She thought others would be interested in them.

Peggy Ford was a kind, caring woman. Her letters to the soldiers made them feel better. One woman thinks Ford is an inspiration. She is _____ (9) others to write to soldiers in Iraq. She says that a letter would bring a smile to a _____ (10) face. Cookies and other treats could be sent with the letters. Small gifts and letters would make the soldiers feel better. She plans to write many letters to soldiers, just as Ford did many years ago. She believes that it's important to say thank you to the soldiers. She thinks the letters would be a good way to do that. She knows that the soldiers appreciate the letters.

IX. COMPOSITION (20 points)

Choose one of the following topics and write a text of at least 160 words.

1. What are your views of English as a global language?
2. Differences between mother language and foreign language.
3. What are the advantages of being bilingual?

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ANSWER KEY**Section I: Reading Comprehension**

1. c 2. c 3. a 4. c 5. c 6. c 7. a 8. a 9. b 10. c

Synonyms: Paw (Hand), Sting (Bite), Banishment (Expulsion), Peacelike (Quiet), Clay (Mud), Whispered (Murmur), Duty (Responsibility), Treason (Betrayal).

Section II: HIV Breakthrough

1. major 2. gap 3. considerable 4. unstable 5. mutate 6. detection 7. However
8. relative 9. blood 10. has 11. rare 12. success.

Section III: Grammar

1. a 2. a 3. a 4. b 5. a 6. a 7. b 8. a 9. a 10. a
11. a 12. b 13. a 14. a 15. a 16. b 17. a 18. b 19. b 20. b
21. b 22. a 23. a 24. a 25. a 26. b 27. b 28. b 29. a 30. a
31. a 32. b 33. b 34. a 35. a 36. b 37. a 38. b 39. b 40. a
41. b 42. b 43. a 44. b 45. b 46. b 47. a 48. a 49. b 50. b

Section IV: Translation

1. a 2. b 3. b 4. c 5. c 6. c 7. a 8. a 9. c 10. c

Section V: Homophones

1. brake 2. grate 3. naval 4. pain 5. paced

Section VI: Vocabulary

1. afraid of / worried about
2. beside / Besides
3. chauffeur / driver
4. yet / already
5. now / actually

Section VII: General Knowledge

1. b 2. b 3. b 4. c 5. a 6. a 7. d 8. d 9. a 10. d

Section VIII: Listening (Peggy Ford)

1. who 2. missed 3. discovered 4. soldier's 5. near 6. offered 7. stationed 8.
saved 9. erguin 10. soldier's